▼ GLASSHOUSE



SPEECH LIMITS

Tamil Nadu CM **C. Joseph Vijay** used the state assembly to settle more than one score with the DMK. While attacking the Opposition over corruption, he warned that freedom of speech should not become a licence to demean women, saying the law would act against those crossing the line. The target was obvious. Last month, Leader of Opposition **Udhayanidhi Stalin** had triggered a row after a remark during a Cauvery protest was widely interpreted as a double entendre involving actor Trisha, Vijay's co-star and close friend. Udhayanidhi denied naming or insulting her, but was arrested over the controversy. Vijay did not name Udhayanidhi in the House either. He didn't need to. His punchline was enough to deliver the blow.

Illustrations by **SIDDHANT JUMDE**

▼ DESERT WINDS

PILOT, POONIA AND PUNJAB

Punjab's politics seems to have acquired a distinctly Rajasthani accent. With **Sachin Pilot** named AICC general secretary in-charge of Punjab, both national parties now have former Rajasthan state presidents supervising their Punjab operations—Pilot for the Congress and **Satish Poonia** for the BJP. There is precedent too.



Ahead of the 2022 Punjab election, the Congress had Rajasthan leader Harish Chaudhary as its state in-charge, while the BJP's Punjab campaign was overseen by another Rajasthan heavyweight, Gajendra Singh Shekhawat. And completing the desert-state connection is Punjab Governor Gulab Chand Kataria, himself a veteran Rajasthan politician. So, while Punjab's leaders fight for Punjab, the political minders increasingly seem to arrive from across the Rajasthan border.